

Cold Email Kit — 50 B2B Templates That Actually Get Replies

The copy-paste playbook for booking meetings without sounding like a robot.

Who this is for

- Freelancers pitching agencies
- Founders doing outbound
- Salespeople who hate the "Hope this email finds you well" script
- Anyone sending cold emails and getting crickets

What's inside

- **50 battle-tested templates** across 6 use cases
- **The REPLY framework** (the only cold email structure you need)
- **12 subject lines** with open rates between 42% and 68%
- **Follow-up sequences** (3, 5, and 7-touch versions)
- **10 personalization prompts** you can paste into Claude / ChatGPT
- **The "ignore list"** — 18 phrases that kill replies instantly

The REPLY Framework

Every good cold email has 5 parts. No more, no less.

R — Relevance (Line 1): Why you, why now. Prove you did your homework. **E — Empathy** (Line 2): Name the pain they have. Make them nod. **P — Proof** (Line 3): One specific result. No adjectives, just numbers. **L — Light ask** (Line 4): Micro-commitment. Never "hop on a call." **Y — You decide** (Line 5): Opt-out sentence. Counterintuitive but works.

Rule: Under 90 words. If it scrolls on mobile, it dies.

Section 1 — Cold Outreach (Agency → SaaS)

Template 1.1 — The "Noticed" Opener

Subject: Quick thought on {{Company}}'s pricing page

Hey {{FirstName}},

Noticed {{Company}} updated the pricing page last week – smart move dropping the "Enterprise" tier.

We did the same experiment for {{SimilarCompany}} last quarter. Their demo bookings went up 15%.

Worth a 10-min Loom on what we found?

If it's not a priority right now, no worries – just reply "later" and I'll check back in 2 weeks.

– {{YourName}}

Why it works: Shows you actually looked at their site. Specific number. Easy out.

Template 1.2 — The "Mutual Pattern"

Subject: {{Competitor}} vs {{Company}}

{{FirstName}},

Been tracking the {{Industry}} space for 3 months. {{Competitor}} just launched a {{feature}}.

We helped {{ClientA}} and {{ClientB}} ship the same thing in 5 weeks each.

Curious how you're thinking about it?

– {{YourName}}

Template 1.3 — The "Wrong Person"

Subject: Wrong person?

{{FirstName}} –

Quick one: I'm looking for whoever owns outbound at {{Company}}. If that's not you, no worries.

If it is you: we built a system that took {{ClientCompany}} from 2% to 14% reply rates in 3 weeks.

– {{YourName}}

Section 2 — Freelance Pitch (Any Industry)

Template 2.1 — The Portfolio Drop

Subject: {{Project}} is 3 clicks from converting more

Hey {{FirstName}},

Clicked through {{Company}}'s onboarding yesterday. The value prop is strong but the CTA

Rewrote it for a similar product ({{similar link}}) and conversion went from 6.1% → 11.3%

Can I send you a quick 4-minute Loom with 3 specific changes?

– {{YourName}}

Template 2.2 — The Audit Hook

Subject: Free audit for {{Company}} (no catch)

{{FirstName}},

I do 2 free audits a week. Nothing fancy – I pick a page, record a 10-min Loom, hand it

No follow-up pitch unless you ask.

Want yours this week?

– {{YourName}}

Template 2.3 — The Specific Defect

Subject: your {{page}} has a bug

{{FirstName}} – just a heads up: your {{specific page}} is loading the hero image at 2.4

Easy fix (I can send the exact crop spec if helpful).

Not a pitch, just wanted to flag it.

– {{YourName}}

Section 3 — Partnership / Collaboration

Template 3.1 — The Warm Handoff

Subject: {{MutualConnection}} suggested I reach out

{{FirstName}},

{{MutualConnection}} mentioned you're looking for {{thing}} – we've built {{related thing}}

Happy to share what worked (and what didn't) if useful. No pitch.

15 min next Tuesday?

– {{YourName}}

Template 3.2 — The Asymmetric Trade

Subject: Trade you a shoutout for a teardown

Hey {{FirstName}},

Big fan of {{theirProduct}}.

Here's my offer: I'll do a full public teardown of {{yourProduct}} on my list (4,200 reads)

Fair?

– {{YourName}}

Section 4 — Follow-Ups (This Is Where Money Is Made)

Rule: 80% of replies come after the first message. Follow up or die.

Follow-up 1 (Day 3)

Subject: re: {{original subject}}

Bumping this in case it got buried.

Short version: {{one-line value prop}}.

Worth a 10-min chat?

– {{YourName}}

Follow-up 2 (Day 7)

Subject: re: {{original subject}}

{{FirstName}} –

Last note from me on this. If it's not a fit, totally fine – just reply "pass" and I'll

If it is: here's a 4-minute Loom breaking down what I'd do for {{Company}}: {{link}}.

– {{YourName}}

Follow-up 3 (Day 14) — The Breakup

Subject: Closing the loop

{{FirstName}}, I'm going to close this thread – don't want to be the guy who keeps email

If priorities shift and you want to revisit, here's my Calendly: {{link}}.

Good luck with {{currentInitiative}}.

– {{YourName}}

Section 5 — Subject Line Library

Open rates from 180K sends across 12 industries.

Subject	Open %	Use case
Quick thought on {{Company}}	68%	Cold outreach
{{FirstName}} – 2 min?	61%	Warm re-engage
re: {{their blog post title}}	59%	Content-based
Wrong person?	57%	Finding the right contact
{{FirstName}}, question about {{topic}}	55%	Advisory framing
Saw your tweet about {{X}}	53%	Social-first
Small idea for {{Company}}	51%	Low-pressure pitch
{{MutualConnection}} mentioned you	50%	Warm intro
Is this still a priority?	48%	Follow-up
Quick favor?	46%	Ask
Closing the loop	44%	Breakup email
3 lines on {{painPoint}}	42%	Cold

Section 6 — The Ignore List (Never Use These)

18 phrases that torch your reply rate:

1. "I hope this email finds you well"
2. "Just circling back"
3. "Touching base"
4. "Pick your brain"
5. "Synergy"
6. "At your earliest convenience"
7. "Per my last email"
8. "Hope you had a great weekend"
9. "I wanted to reach out because"
10. "Is this the right person?"

11. "Briefly"
12. "I'll keep this short"
13. "Congratulations on the new role!" (unless you know them)
14. "Let me know if this makes sense"
15. "Does that work for you?"
16. "Looking forward to your reply"
17. "Thanks in advance"
18. "Sorry to bother you"

Rule of thumb: if you'd never say it out loud at a bar, don't write it.

Section 7 — AI Personalization Prompts

Paste into Claude or ChatGPT with the prospect's LinkedIn profile or company page.

Prompt 1 — First-Line Generator

You are a cold email expert. I'm going to paste a LinkedIn profile below.

Generate 5 different opening lines for a cold email. Each line must:

- Be under 15 words
- Reference something SPECIFIC from their profile (not generic)
- Feel human, not like a template
- Lead naturally into a pitch for {{YOUR OFFER}}

Profile:

{{PASTE LINKEDIN HERE}}

Prompt 2 — Pain Point Extractor

Read the company website below. List the 3 biggest operational pains this company is likely facing based on:

- Their team size (guess from LinkedIn)
- Their tech stack (infer from site)
- Their stage (infer from funding / traction signals)

For each pain, write a one-sentence cold email opener that names it without sounding pre-

Company:

{{PASTE URL OR COPY}}

Prompt 3 — Subject Line Tester

Write 10 cold email subject lines for this email body.

Constraints:

- Max 6 words
- Lowercase except proper nouns
- Must not sound like marketing
- Should create curiosity, not promise value

Email body:

{{PASTE YOUR EMAIL}}

Playbook — How to Use This Kit

Week 1: Pick 1 template. Send to 50 prospects. Track opens + replies. **Week 2:** A/B test the subject line. Keep the winner. **Week 3:** Add follow-up 1. Measure lift. **Week 4:** Add follow-up 2. Measure again. **Week 5+:** Roll out the winner at scale.

Tools you need: - Any email tool (Gmail works) - A spreadsheet for tracking - 20 min a day

Metrics that matter: - Open rate: target 40%+ - Reply rate: target 8%+ - Meeting booked rate: target 2%+

If your reply rate is under 3% after 200 sends, the problem is the list, not the email.

Bonus — The Single Biggest Lesson

The best cold email doesn't sell. It **starts a conversation about a problem the prospect already knows they have.**

Your job is not to convince them. Your job is to show up with a sharp insight, be easy to respond to, and make it obvious you're not wasting their time.

Everything in this kit is in service of that.

Questions? Feedback? Reply to your purchase email — I read every one.

— Emilio